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Digital Tools

Technology For Personal And SoHo Productivity

Enhance

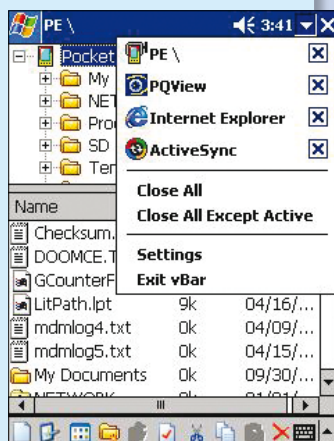
MUST-HAVE WINDOWS MOBILE APPS

Get them now,
that's an order!

Aditya Madanapalle

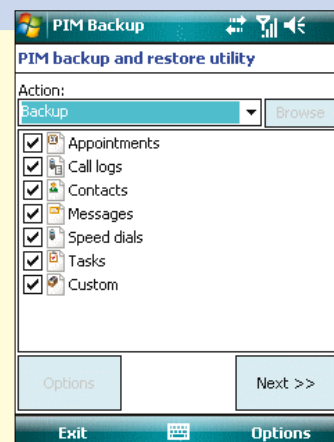
Task Manager

vBar is a task manager for windows mobile devices available as a free download from <http://vieka.com/vbar.htm>. The vBar icon locates itself neatly in the title bar, and has two basic options for closing applications—close all, and close all but active. The software itself is very small (21 KB) and has a small memory footprint as well. You can change the color settings, as well as the order in which the buttons in the menu appears. Another excellent feature is an option to show tiny bars indicating the memory and battery usage instead of the drop down icon.



Data Backup

PIM backup is a free backup software from www.dotfred.net. Contacts, call logs, messages, speed dials, tasks and other files can be backed up. It is possible to backup information from one device and restore it in another. The data is backed up in a .pib file, which is just a .zip file so some data can be edited on a computer. There are a number of data restoration options, like updating the data, adding only new data, deleting all existing data and making duplicates of the data. There are two format options for backing up the data, binary and text-based. The binary format is faster, but the text based format is easier to edit on a computer. There is also a setting that allows the data to be compressed, and a scheduler feature which backs up data automatically when scheduled.



PDF Viewer

The official pdf viewer for the windows mobile platform is available for free from www.adobe.com/products/acrobat/readerforppc.html. The viewer is a 13 MB download. The reader optimises high quality PDF content for viewing on a Windows mobile device, with both a portrait and a landscape mode available. A full screen mode and a reflow toggle is included. There are two preset zoom options, the fit width and the default zoom, and a custom zoom option. The hand and the text selection tool are included. The various options available while creating PDF content are preserved when viewed on a windows mobile device—for example any page transitions show up as well as attached slideshows.

